

Modern Classics

After World War II had broadened horizons for millions of people worldwide and thousands had learned to fly. As peace was established and prosperity returned, more and more would take up flying as a leisure activity. Stylish and sporty aircraft flooded the market to cater to this demand, along with simple, cheap amateur-build options, and there was also a steady increase in the popularity of gliding.



△ **Gerdan GY-201 Minicab 1950**
Origin France
Engine 65 hp Continental A65-8F
 air-cooled flat-4
Top speed 123 mph (198 km/h)

First flown in 1949 this inexpensive, lightweight two-seater was designed by Yves Gerdan for Constructions Aéronautiques du Béarn, which built 22. Around 140 more were kit-built worldwide.



△ **Piper PA-18 Super Cub 1950**
Origin USA
Engine 150 hp Lycoming O-320
 air-cooled flat-4
Top speed 153 mph (246 km/h)

Derived from the Taylor Cub of 1930, this is a 1993-built aircraft of a type that went into production in 1949-50. It was capable of operating from small fields; around 15,000 were built and many are still flying.



△ **Piper PA-23 Apache 1953**
Origin USA
Engine 2 x 150 hp Lycoming O-320-A
 air-cooled flat-4
Top speed 215 mph (346 km/h)

Popular for its spacious four-to six-seat interior and high weight-carrying ability, this was the first twin-engined Piper. Designed by Stinson, 6,976 were built, in various forms, up to 1981.



△ **Cessna 170B 1952**
Origin USA
Engine 145 hp Continental O-300-A
 air-cooled flat-6
Top speed 143 mph (230 km/h)

In 1952 the successful Cessna 170 was updated with a wing design that continued on small Cessnas well into the 21st century, with modified Fowler wing flaps and a new tailplane.



△ **Stits SA-2A Sky Baby 1952**
Origin USA
Engine 112 hp Continental C-85 flat-4
Top speed 220 mph (354 km/h)

Designed by WWII fighter pilot Ray Stits to be the "world's smallest" aircraft, this tiny biplane required a 170-lb (77-kg) pilot to maintain its center of gravity. It did 25 hours of display flying before retirement.



△ **Cessna 180 Skywagon 1952**
Origin USA
Engine 225 hp Continental O-470-A
 air-cooled flat-6
Top speed 170 mph (274 km/h)

A more spacious and powerful alternative to the 170, the all-metal framed semimonocoque 180 was produced in updated forms until 1981, by which time 6,193 had been built.



△ **Piaggio P149 1953**
Origin Italian design/German built
Engine 190 hp Lycoming GO-435-A
 air-cooled flat-6
Top speed 145 mph (233 km/h)

The Italian Piaggio P149 was built under license in Germany as the Focke-Wulf FwP149D. It was a four-to five-seat touring aircraft that was used by the German Air Force for training and utility purposes.